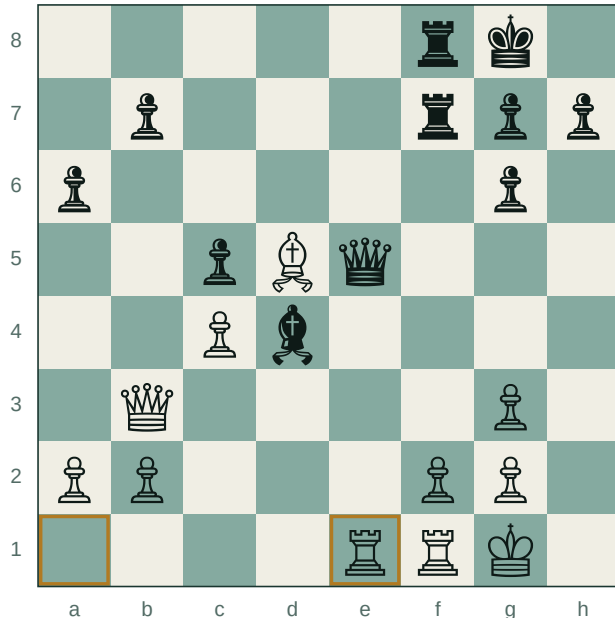


Attraction tactics: Black, move 26

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Rae1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Bxf2+ 27. Rxf2 Qxe1+ 28. Kh2 Qxf2

26...Bxf2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From f2 it attacks king on g1 and rook on e1. Recorded reply: **27.Rxf2**.

27...Qxe1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From e1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on f2. Recorded reply: **28.Kh2**.

28...Qxf2 The queen captures the rook on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from +0 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on f2.